NOVEMBER 2008

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

THE HISTORY OF MOFFETT FIELD AND HANGAR ONE – PRESENTED BY BERNIE McDONOUGH NOVEMBER 2, 2008 @ 2 PM

Bernie McDonough, of the Moffett Field Historic Society, will give a presentation of the history of Moffett Field as well as Hangar One.

*****URGENT NOTICE*****

Our History Museum and Education Center needs your help NOW. Please see page 3 for our message.

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Executive Committee can make changes in procedure as the need arises. Please review the proposed changes and bring any thoughts or questions that you may have to the November meeting. Patricia Figueroa has put considerable time and effort into these revisions and we owe her a large debt of gratitude for her efforts.

I am thrilled with our Associations new web site,Mountainviewhistorical.org. We have updated information about our meetings, membership and the History Museum, with links to other local Historical Associations and Museums. Thanks to the generosity of Katia Kamangar, of SummerHill Homes, we now have a beautiful watercolor rendering of the proposed History Museum and Education Center posted in the Museum area of the site. Many thanks also to our Museum's Architect, Lewis Alvernas, of HDR, for the colorful site plans and hours of work on the drawings also posted there. We will be adding several more images to this area during the next month so stay tuned. The Executive Committee also voted to establish a phone number with Voice Mail for the Association so we can connect there as well.

Our storage container arrived in August and is ready to accept items donated to the Association until the Museum is opened. Shelving needs to be installed and we have been asked to give the exterior a coat of paint so that it blends in with its neighbors, so we will be having a painting party soon.

This will be my final message as your President, as I leave office with the elections in November. The two years have gone by quickly, but not so fast that I haven't made many new friends and learned so much from them. I wish to thank my Executive Committee for all the time and hard work they gave to the Association. Without their tireless dedication the Mountain View Historical Association wouldn't exist.

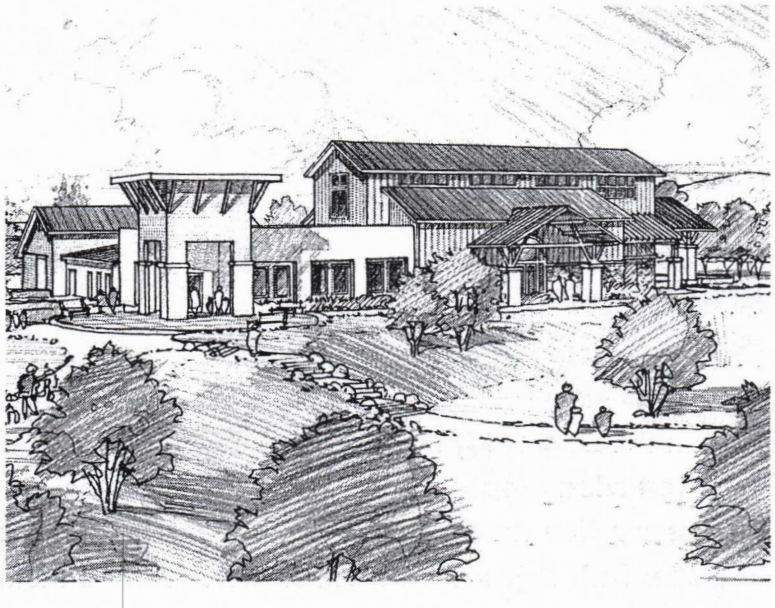
The Nominations Committee has proposed this slate of officers for the next term: President, Honor Spitz; Vice-President, Vivian Schatz; Secretary, Margaret Peterson; Treasurer, Patricia Figueroa. Please support them with your votes and your attendance during their term.

It has indeed been an honor to serve this Association as President. From the ranks I emerged and to the ranks I now return.

Best Wishes to you all.

URGENT NOTICE

Our History Museum and Education Center needs your help NOW.

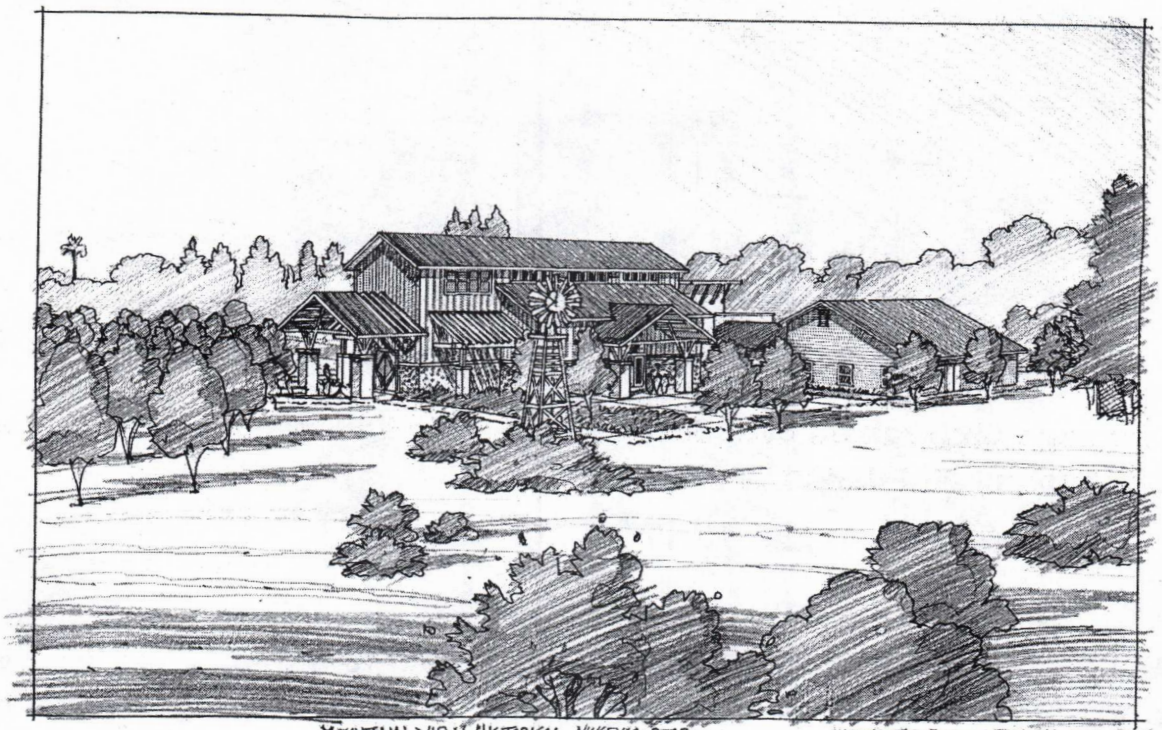


The Mountain View Historical Association's plan to establish a History Museum and Educational Center for our community is facing two critical votes. The first vote will be at the Parks and Recreation Commission meeting, in early November, and the second will be with the City Council, in early December. I know that many of you cannot attend these meetings; however you can help by writing a quick note or sending an email expressing your support for our project. Please take a minute to do this, as it will have impact. Please visit our web site at

www.mountainviewhistorical.org

to learn more about the Museum and what it will bring to our community. Please address your letters to: Helen Kim, Public Works Department, City of Mountain View, 500 Castro Street, Mountain View, CA 94041. Send e-mails to Helen.kim@mountainview.gov.

Meeting information: (1) Parks and Recreation Commission, Center for the Performing Arts, 2nd Stage, Wednesday, November 9.
(2) City Council Meeting, City Hall Council Chamber, Tuesday, December 9



MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL MUSEUM - REAR
- SKETCH -

ILLUSTRATOR: BARNEY DAVIDSON ASSOC. 9/1/08

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS: COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 YEARS AGO (1908): Of the 147 total votes cast in a special bond election, 30 were against the $40,000 for sewers, 39 did not want a $80,000 city hall and jail, while 41 voted against buying a lot on which to place the buildings being voted on.

Several Presbyterian Church choir members were married in 1908: Elizabeth Burns and Wilbur L. Camp, Ella Cooper and William Bubb, and choir director, Grace Clark became the bride of the young pastor, Reverend Wilhelm Spaan.

The Woman's Club raised over $50 for the public library from a combined bazaar, musical and dance in Swall Hall.

75 YEARS AGO (1933): From the High School's column, Read 'Em and Weep: Miss Birkland: So you want to join the commercial class? Can you type? John Axell: I can type, but not right.

The dirigible U.S.S. Macon arrived at the Sunnyvale Air Base on Sunday, October 15, 1933 at 4 pm to a welcoming crowd of 100,000.

A gambling resort, The Macon, on Whisman Road, opposite the air base, was raided for the second time. Six workers were arrested, but patrons were not held.

The Redwine Motor Company has started to remodel its warehouse on the corner of Dana and Bryant Streets into a theatre (Cinema Theatre).

The Blue and White Kennel Club on Eunice Avenue was raided and the Sheriff found a "gambling layout, bar room, dog kennels, etc." George White, proprietor, was arrested and held for a hearing.

Two Castro Street hardware stores were closing. Harley Hardware, after more than 20 years at Castro and Villa Streets, was selling out and Walter Doust was closing Growers' Hardware in order to purchase an interest in the Air Base laundry.

50 YEARS AGO (1958): A gas war has spread from the Berkeley-Oakland area clear down to Mountain View where prices have dropped four or five cents to 30 cents a gallon for regular and 35 cents for premium.

Jack Isadore, 35, is the new Assistant City Manager, replacing Ted Craig. Isadore attended local schools and San Jose State before entering the Navy. The salary for this position is $6,212 per year.

Open house was held Sunday, October 19, 1958, at the new 8,438 square foot library at 585 Franklin Street. The previous location was at 939 Dana Street with only 2,000 square feet. Even so, Librarian, Edith Duke, predicts that an addition will be needed within five years. Staff now consists of five plus Ms. Duke and her assistant, Ruth Lawson.

25 YEARS AGO (1983): A Mountain View resident is the bad guy in the Minuteman Spy Case, which has been called "the biggest espionage operation in US history." James D. Harper, 49, of 1931 California Street, admitted that he and his late wife, Rub Louise Schuler, sold missile defense information to Polish agents, who in turn, passed it to the Soviets. The FBI believes Harper may have received One Million dollars.

An unbeaten season earned the St. Francis' Lancers, coached by Ron Calcagno, the West Catholic Athletic League Championship and then the Central Coast championship. With 25 consecutive wins, the Lancers have the longest winning streak in California prep football.

Mel Inouye, Mountain View rose grower, reported that 17% of roses in the Bay Area are now coming from Columbia, Israel, Holland and Mexico; all with good weather and lower labor costs. Local growers are feeling the pressure.

Contour Medical Systems of Mountain View, working with Collagen Corporation of Palo Alto, is working to find materials, other than human bone, for use in implants.

STREET TALK: BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Old Middlefield Way is the original portion of Middlefield Road. It wasn't until late in 1983 that the City Council decided on the route for an

extension of Middlefield Road from the San Antonio Road area, across the city and beyond Alviso Road.

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER: BY BARBARA KINCHEN

[Note: Call for local High School Yearbooks--Remember the History Room accepts donations of yearbooks when you are at a yard sale or sorting and cleaning.]

From member, Audrey Jarvis Hoke of San Diego: "90 Years of Mountain View Fire Department History" by James S. Graham, Audrey's cousin (of the Isaac Newton Graham family, (one of the pioneer families). An 8.5 x 11 inch, 1935 or 1936, photo of Junior Woodman of the World. Included in the picture is Audrey, her brothers, Leland and Harold, and their father, Fred Jarvis, and cousin Ruth Marie McKinley of Sunnyvale. Also identified is one of the Telmont boys, either Hip or Des.

From member Richard M. Smith of Mountain View: "Now and Then, Exploring Mountain View's Architectural Heritage" and several items which belonged to his late wife, Nancy King, a local high school graduate. Included were yearbooks for 1957 and 1981; a brochure of the 1957 class reunion with pictures and names; a photo of attendees at the 1953-1958 reunion; colored photo of the high school; several short histories of the school; words for the Alma Mater and an obituary for Mrs. Frances Kagawa, long-time assistant to the school nurse.

I REMEMBER: MEMORIES OF MOUNTAIN VIEW 80 YEARS AGO SENT IN BY WALTER FRIGERIO

I attended the Dana Street School, High Way School (at Calderon) and the Mountain View High School on Castro Street. I was gone from Mountain View from 1941 until 1945. The "Mountain View Hotel" was my home until 1941; from 1945-1947 a house on Villa Street. At the hotel, we rented rooms for 50 cents a night, unless you wanted a room with a window and then it was 75 cents a night. The charge for room and board was $7 a week. My

mother sold homemade ravioli with sauce for 50 cents a quart; I shined shoes on Castro Street for 5 cents and sold papers for 3 cents each.

I remember: a bank explosion at Villa and Castro Street; a murder at a restaurant on Villa Street (China town); a chicken thief that I caught in our back yard; a Mountain View cop taking me home (too much partying); receiving a special driver's license at 13 (man of the house); five of us jumping onto a train freight car to San Jose to see a hanging at St. James Park. In 1946, I went into Thrower's Fountain to buy a milk-shake and later (1947) married the girl that had been behind the counter that day.

[Please share your memories with us. We would like to hear what you remember. Send your entries to: MVHA, P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042-0252].

THANKS TO THE AUGUST BBQ RAFFLE DONATORS:

Book Buyers on Castro; Hobee's at Central Expressway and Rengstorff; Country Gourmet on El Camino, MV; Fulfillment Systems Inc. Restaurant/Frankie and Johnnie and Luigi Too, Sunnyvale; In and Out Burger on Rengstorff; LeBoulanger on Castro; Kapp's Pizza Bar on Castro; Baskin & Robbins on El Camino, MV; Clark's Charcoal Broiler on El Camino, MV; Century Cinema on Shoreline; Michael's Restaurant on Shoreline, MV Performing Arts on Castro; Rhode & Associates/Burger King on El Camino, MV; Red Rock Coffee on Castro, Starbuck's Coffee on Castro; Sizzler Restaurant on El Camino, MV; Chevy's Restaurant on El Camino, MV; Tony & Alba's Pizza on Escuela; Domino's Pizza on El Camino, MV; Roger's Deli on E. Middlefield, MV; Decoupage Hair & Skincare on W. Dana; Elegance Hair Salon on W. Dana and Kevin's Auto Repair on Leghorn.

MVHA'S INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT

Beginning balance as of July 1, 2008: $13,823.66

Income: $2,764.15

Expenses: ($4,134.63)

Ending balance as of June 30, 2008: $12,453.07

MEMBERSHIP REPORT: BY JUNE CASEY

A/S = Single Members	99
A/F = Family Members	68
LM = Life Members	118
HM = Honored Members	2

TOTAL MEMBERS @ 10/01/2008: 287

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

President	Robert Weaver
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	Craig Holden
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President (not active)	Nick Galiotto
Newsletter Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity	Honor Spitz
Hospitality	Laura Brown
Memorials & Remembrances	Hip Telmont (new to post)
Ways & Means	Preeti Piplani (new to post)
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

IN MEMORIAM

MARION GRIMM passed away in her sleep on July 15, 2008 at the age of 85. She is survived by her husband, Bob; four children, Thomas Grimm, Sue Cummings, Mike Grimm and Patty Grimm. Along with her husband, former Los Altos Mayor Bob Grimm, Marion was a major financial contributor and visionary in the formation of the Los Altos Museum. Bob is currently very active in assisting with the formation of the future Mountain View History Museum. Marion was a life member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

TERRY KLINE was born October 13, 1948 and passed away on July 21, 2008 from a brain tumor. Terry is survived by his wife, Helena and daughter, Raquel. Terry attended Bubb Elementary, Graham Junior High and graduated from Awalt High School in 1966. Terry's parents, Arnold and Mildred Kline, were owners of Kline's Workingman's store on Castro Street in the 1950s. Terry was a life member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

RUTH WATSON LAWSON was born on January 24, 1921 and passed away on August 24, 2008. She is survived by her husband of 68 years, Donald and daughters: Judith Lawson, Janet Witt, Carol Storey and Beth Hyland. Ruth received her M.A. in Librarianship at San Jose State University and was the Director of the City of Mountain View Public Library from 1972-1981